



San Mateo County CA SO Transparency Portal

Last updated: Mon Aug 24 2026



privacy. San Mateo County CA SO utilizes retroactive search to solve crimes after they've occurred. Additionally, San Mateo County CA SO utilizes real time alerting of hotlist vehicles to capture wanted criminals. Flock Safety technology also assists in the reuniting of missing persons with their loved ones. In an effort to ensure proper usage and guardrails are in place, San Mateo County CA SO have made the below policies and usage statistics available to the public.

Community Impact

Featured Success Stories

Success Story - Occupied Stolen Vehicle

On Sunday, 07/05/26, at about 5:30am, deputies received a FLOCK alert regarding a vehicle with stolen license plates in the area of Woodside Rd. and Alameda De Las Pulgas. By tracking the suspect vehicle via FLOCK, deputies were able to locate the occupied vehicle in the 100 block of Northgate Dr. in Woodside. Deputies successfully stopped the vehicle and during a thorough investigation, discovered that both the vehicle and the license plates were stolen. The occupants of the vehicle also possessed possible ID theft information, several other stolen license plates, a variety of power tools, and suspected methamphetamine. The stolen vehicle was ultimately released to the registered owner. Both suspects were arrested and booked into the San Mateo County Jail for violations of numerous criminal statutes. FLOCK was integral to the identification and location of the suspect vehicle. This case highlights how proactive enforcement and the use of FLOCK can solve crimes and prevent future ones.

Success Story - Felony Hit & Run

On 07/01/26, at approximately 6:45 p.m., deputies responded to Woodside Rd. and Hacienda Dr. in Woodside following a reported hit-and-run collision. Upon arrival, deputies learned the victim was riding a horse along the shoulder of the road, which is commonly used by bicyclists and equestrians, when a vehicle struck the horse from behind and fled the scene. Both the horse and rider sustained injuries but survived. Through witness statements and investigative tools, including FLOCK, deputies identified the involved vehicle and registered owners. Deputies are continuing to conduct follow-up investigative work, including collecting and reviewing all available evidence. The use of FLOCK greatly reduced the time it took for deputies to identify the suspect vehicle.

Success Story - Residential Burglary

On 06/15/2026, deputies investigated a report of a 2-day old residential burglary in the Town of Woodside. Home security footage showed two suspects entering the garage on the property and rummaging through items. When the home's alarm system activated, the suspects fled. Deputies reviewed the footage, which showed the vehicle the suspects were driving.

Using FLOCK, deputies identified the vehicle and focused their investigation. On 06/16/26, deputies located the vehicle in Redwood City. Two suspects were arrested for PC 460(A): Residential Burglary. Though this case was reported 2-days after the crime occurred, FLOCK allowed deputies to quickly identify and arrest the suspects.

Success Story - Road Rage / Firearm / Narcotics

On 06/14/2026, around 8:30 p.m., deputies were dispatched to a location in Montara following reports of a road rage incident. During the incident, the suspect reportedly pointed a firearm at the victim, was speeding, and driving erratically. The suspect fled the area, but witnesses were able to provide a description of the suspect and the vehicle he was driving. Using FLOCK, deputies identified the vehicle and were able to focus their search efforts. A short time later, deputies located the suspect nearby. During the investigation, deputies located a semi-automatic firearm, ammunition, narcotics, illegal fireworks, and a false registration tab in the suspect’s possession. The suspect, who was already prohibited from possessing firearms, was arrested on several charges including: PC 245(A)(2): Assault with a firearm, PC 29800(a)(1): Felon in possession of a firearm, and HS 11351: Possession of a controlled substance for sale. The use of FLOCK in this case greatly shortened the time it took for deputies to locate and safely arrest a dangerous felon.

Success Story - Stolen Vehicle

On 06/06/2026, Sheriff's Deputies in unincorporated Redwood City were alerted to a stolen vehicle in the area, via a FLOCK notification. Deputies responded to the area and quickly located the occupied vehicle. Deputies initiated a traffic stop but the driver failed to yield, which led to a short vehicle pursuit. At the conclusion of the pursuit, deputies safely and successfully took the juvenile driver into custody. The driver was also in possession of burglary tools. He was arrested for possession of a stolen vehicle, evading a peace officer with wanton disregard for public safety, and possession of burglary tools. This case highlights the effectiveness of using FLOCK's automated license plate reader (ALPR) technology in supporting public safety and preventing future crimes.

Success Story - Best Buy Serial Computer/Laptop Thief

On 02/23/2024 and 03/23/2024, a suspect entered the Best Buy in San Carlos and stole multiple computers and laptops valued at approximately \$3,000. A suspect vehicle was observed fleeing the scene, and FLOCK enabled deputies to obtain a license plate for the vehicle. Detectives identified a family member of the registered vehicle owner who matched the suspect's description. It was discovered that this suspect had committed similar thefts at Best Buy stores throughout the Bay Area. Detectives and deputies learned of a new suspect vehicle being used by the perpetrator, and FLOCK assisted in identifying this vehicle. In April 2024, deputies and detectives monitored the suspect and the vehicle in question. The suspect returned to the Best Buy in San Carlos on 04/27/2024, where he was arrested for the previous thefts.

Success Story - Arson via Molotov Cocktail

On 05/16/2024, around 3:00am, a suspect threw a Molotov cocktail at a residence in San Carlos. The fire spread rapidly, resulting in the destruction of two vehicles, part of a residential garage, some exterior property, and a section of a tree. Fortunately, the residents managed to escape the area unharmed. Using surveillance video and FLOCK, investigators identified a suspect vehicle that left the area shortly after the incident. With this information, they were able to develop additional leads on the suspect. Search warrants were issued and investigators obtained additional surveillance footage and FLOCK images, which clearly linked the suspect to the arson. This information resulted in the arrest of a suspect, who was prosecuted for arson of an inhabited structure by the San Mateo County District Attorney.

Success Story - Residential Burglary/Package Thefts from Apartments

On 08/06/2024 and 08/07/2024, during the early morning hours, two suspects entered different apartment buildings in San Carlos without access or authorization. These suspects entered the mailrooms and stole multiple packages from both buildings. Using surveillance video, detectives obtained descriptions of the suspects and their vehicle. Through FLOCK, a suspect vehicle was located. Detectives and deputies identified one of the involved suspects, who was on post-release community supervision out of Alameda County. They arranged for the probation officer to bring the suspect into the Hayward Probation Office. Detectives contacted the suspect at the office and found additional evidence related to these cases. This case is under review by the San Mateo County District Attorney for prosecution.

Success Story - Missing Person Safely Located

On 08/04/26 at approximately 11:00pm, the Sheriff’s Office was notified by another California law enforcement agency that a missing person's vehicle had been detected by Flock ALPR within the Sheriff's Office jurisdiction, near the City of San Carlos. The missing person was designated at risk due to age and ability to care for themselves. Deputies quickly located the missing person, ensured their health and safety, and safely reunited them with their family. This case highlights how the cooperation and sharing of Flock ALPR access with partnering agencies can help reunite families with their missing loved ones.

Data & Usage Summary

Data Retention

The number of days data is retained.

30 days

Total Cameras

Number of LPR and other cameras.

109

Vehicles detected in the last 30 days

Number of unique plate reads over the last 30 days.

1,209,032

Number of Searches

Total user search sessions over the last 30 days.

1,086

Hotlists Alerted On

National and statewide hotlist sources.

California SVS, NCMEC Amber Alert

Number of Hotlist Hits

Total hotlist hits over the last 30 days.

8,685

Sharing Network Data With

Organizations granted access to San Mateo County CA SO data.

Alameda CA PD

Alameda County CA SO

Albany CA PD

Alhambra CA PD

Anaheim CA PD

Anderson CA PD

Angels Camp CA PD

Antioch CA PD

Arcadia CA PD

Atherton CA PD

Barstow CA PD

Bear Valley Springs CA PD

Beaumont CA PD

Belmont CA PD

Belvedere CA PD

Benicia CA PD

Berkeley CA PD

Brentwood CA PD

Brisbane CA PD

Burlingame CA PD

Cal Fire

California Department of Corrections

California Department of Fish & Wildlife (CA)
California State Parks
Campbell CA PD
Carmel CA PD
Central Marin CA PD
Citrus Heights CA PD
City of Monte Sereno CA
Claremont CA PD
Clearlake CA PD
Colma CA PD
Concord CA PD
Corona CA PD
Cypress CA PD
Danville CA PD
Dixon CA PD
East Bay Parks CA PD
El Dorado County CA SO
Elk Grove CA PD
Escalon CA PD
Folsom CA PD
Foster City CA PD
Fowler CA PD
Fresno CA PD
Galt CA PD
Gilroy CA PD
Grass Valley CA PD
Grover Beach CA PD
Hanford CA PD
Hemet CA PD
Hermosa Beach PD CA
Hollister CA PD
Imperial City CA PD
Indio CA PD

California Highway Patrol
Calistoga CA PD
Capitola CA PD
Cathedral City CA PD
Cerritos College CA PD
City of Lemoore CA
City of San Dimas CA (LASD)
Clayton CA PD
Cloverdale CA PD
Colusa CA PD
Contra Costa County CA SO
Cotati CA PD
Daly City CA PD
Desert Hot Springs CA PD
Dublin CA PD (ACSO)
East Palo Alto CA PD
El Segundo CA PD
Emeryville CA PD
Fairfield CA PD
Fort Bragg CA PD
Fountain Valley CA PD
Fremont CA PD
Fullerton CA PD
Garden Grove CA PD
Glendora (CA) PD
Greenfield CA PD
Gustine PD CA
Hayward CA PD
Hercules CA PD
Hillsborough CA PD
Humboldt County CA SO
Imperial County CA SO
Irvine CA PD

Irwindale CA PD

Kerman CA PD

Kings County CA DAs Office

La Habra CA PD

La Verne CA PD

Lake County CA SO

Lancaster CA PD

Lincoln CA PD

Livingston CA PD

Lompoc CA PD

Los Altos CA PD

Los Angeles County CA SD

Los Gatos CA

Madera County SO CA

Marin County CA DA

Marina CA PD

Mendocino County SO-CA

Menifee CA PD

Merced County CA SO

Milpitas CA PD

Montclair CA PD

Monterey County CA SO

Monterey Park CA PD

Morgan Hill CA PD

Napa CA PD

National City CA PD

Nevada City CA PD

Newark CA PD

Novato CA PD

Oakley CA PD

Ontario CA PD

Orange County (CA) DA Office

Kensington CA PD

Kern County CA SO

Kings County Sheriff's Office CA

La Mesa CA PD

Laguna Beach CA PD

Lakeport CA PD

Lathrop CA PD

Livermore CA PD

Lodi CA PD

Los Alamitos PD CA

Los Angeles CA PD

Los Angeles Port Police CA

Madera CA PD

Manteca CA PD

Marin County CA SO

McFarland CA PD

Mendota CA PD

Menlo Park CA PD

Mill Valley CA PD

Modoc County CA SO

Monterey CA PD

Monterey County District Attorney's Office

Moraga CA PD

Murrieta CA PD

Napa County CA SO

NCRIC

Nevada County CA SO

Newport Beach PD CA

Oakland CA PD

Oceanside CA PD

Orange CA PD

Orange County Fire Authority (CA)

Orange County SO CA

Pacific Grove CA PD

Palm Springs CA PD

Pasadena CA PD

Piedmont CA PD

Placer County CA DA Office

Pleasant Hill CA PD

Pomona CA PD

Porterville CA PD

Redlands CA PD

Redwood City CA PD

Rialto PD CA

Ridgecrest CA PD

Rio Vista CA PD

Riverside County CA District Attorney

Rocklin CA PD

Roseville CA PD

Sacramento County CA SO

San Benito County SO CA

San Bernardino Community College CA PD

San Bruno CA PD

San Diego County CA SO

San Fernando CA PD

San Francisco District Attorney CA

San Joaquin CA DA

San Jose CA PD

San Luis Obispo CA PD

San Mateo CA PD

San Pasqual CA PD

San Ramon CA PD

Sanger CA PD

Santa Barbara County CA SO

Santa Clara CA PD

Oroville CA PD

Pacifica CA PD

Palo Alto CA PD

Petaluma CA PD

Placentia CA PD

Placer County CA SO

Pleasanton CA PD

Port of Stockton CA PD

Redding PD - CA

Redondo Beach CA PD

Reedley CA PD

Richmond CA PD

Rio Hondo College PD CA

RIV CO ARSON TF CA PD

Riverside County CA SO

Rohnert Park Department of Public Safety (CA)

Sacramento CA DA

Salinas CA PD

San Bernardino CA PD

San Bernardino County CA SO

San Diego CA PD

San Diego Harbor CA PD

San Francisco CA PD

San Gabriel CA PD

San Joaquin County CA SO

San Leandro CA PD

San Luis Obispo County (CA) Sheriff

San Pablo CA PD

San Rafael CA PD

Sand City CA PD

Santa Ana CA PD

Santa Barbara PD CA

Santa Clara County CA SO

Santa Clara DA CA	Santa Maria CA PD
Santa Monica CA PD	Santa Rosa CA PD
Sausalito CA PD	Seal Beach CA PD
Seaside CA PD	Selma CA PD
Shasta County SO	Simi Valley CA PD
Solano County CA SO	Solano County DA CA
What's Detected	What's Not Detected
Soledad CA PD	Sonoma County CA SO
License Plates, Vehicles	Facial recognition, People, Gender, Race
South Gate CA PD	South Pasadena CA PD
St. Helena CA PD	St. Placido PD
Acceptable Use Policy	Prohibited Uses
Station Springs CA PD	Immigration enforcement, traffic enforcement,
Data is used for law enforcement purposes only.	harrassment or intimidation, usage based solely on a
Data is owned by San Mateo County CA SO and is	protected class (i.e. race, sex, religion), Personal use.
never sold to 3rd parties.	
Sutter County CA SO	Taft CA PD
Access Policy	Tehama County CA SO
Tehachapi CA PD	
All system access requires a valid reason and is stored indefinitely.	Town of Woodside CA (SMCSO)
Tiburon CA PD	Trinity County SO CA
Transparency	Tulare CA PD
Hotels are required to be human verified prior to action.	
Tulare County CA SO	Turlock CA PD
Tustin CA PD	Ukiah CA PD
Union City CA PD	Upland CA PD
Vacaville CA PD	Vallejo CA PD
Ventura CA PD	Ventura County CA SO
Ventura County District Attorney's Office CA	Vernon CA PD
Visalia CA PD	Walnut Creek CA PD
San Mateo Sheriff's Office ALPR Policy	West Covina CA PD
Watsonville CA PD	https://www.smcsheriff.com/sites/default/files/content_files/Automated_License_Plate_Readers_ALPRs_0.pdf
West Sacramento CA PD	Westminster CA PD
Wheatland CA PD	Whittier CA PD
Williams CA PD	Willits CA PD
Winters CA PD	Woodlake CA PD
Woodland CA PD	Yolo County CA SO
Yreka CA PD	Yuba City CA PD
Yuba County Sheriffs Office	

Policy & Trust

More Info

Provided by Flock Safety